

IT Act 2000

Information Technology Act, 2000

Information Technology (IT) Act, 2000

User Query :

A business dispute is pending in court. One party has produced a digitally signed PDF agreement and a series of emails to prove that I accepted certain contractual terms. I believe the PDF may have been altered after I signed an earlier version and I dispute that the final document is genuine. What legal provisions govern the authenticity and admissibility of these digital records?

Job Id. : qwen3-30b/Scenario 13/Information Technology (IT) Act, 2000

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AI-Powered Legal Intelligence Platform

APPLICABLE SECTIONS

Section 3 — Authentication of electronic records

Relevant to digital-signature authentication.

Section 3A — Electronic signature

Provides the framework for reliable electronic signatures/authentication techniques.

Section 4 — Legal recognition of electronic records

Recognises electronic records where law requires writing.

Section 5 — Legal recognition of electronic signatures

Recognises electronic signatures where law requires signing/authentication.

Section 14 — Secure electronic record

Relevant if a security procedure was applied to the record.

Section 15 — Secure electronic signature

Relevant if the signature satisfies the statutory secure-signature conditions.

INTERPRETATION & LEGAL ANALYSIS

AI-generated legal interpretation

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- These IT Act provisions concern authentication and legal recognition. Do not substitute adjudication provisions or repealed evidence-law numbering for the current authentication framework.

✓ STRENGTHS & RIGHTS

- 1
- A digitally signed PDF directly raises authentication and secure-signature questions.

✗ RISKS & OBLIGATIONS

- 1
- Whether the final PDF was altered is a factual/forensic question; the mere presence of a digital signature does not automatically prove every version is genuine.

PROCEDURAL NOTES & COMPLIANCE STEPS

Actionable steps for compliance and grievance redressal

COMPLIANCE STEPS

1. Preserve both versions, signature certificate details, hashes and email headers.
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